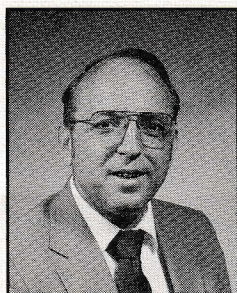


SOUTHEASTERN

Free Will Baptist College

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Ecclesiastical Separation

A.B. Brown

The ultimate goal of Christ for His Church is that He might one day present Her as a "... glorious church, not having spot, or wrinkle, or any such thing; but that it should be holy and without blemish" (Eph. 5:27). This holy and unblemished Church includes both personal purity and theological purity. (They usually go together. If an individual, a church, or a denomination loses its personal purity, it will not be long before its theological purity is compromised.)

The importance God places on both personal and theological purity is seen in I Tim. 4:16 where Paul warns Timothy to first take heed unto himself and then his doctrine. He wrote, "Take heed unto thyself, and unto the doctrine; continue in them: for in doing this thou shalt both save thyself, and them that hear thee." According to this passage, the abandonment of the Pauline doctrine posed a serious threat both to Timothy and those who heard him. In Romans 16:17, Paul warns, "Now I beseech you, brethren, mark them which cause divisions and offenses contrary to the doctrine which ye have learned; and avoid them." The Church of Jesus Christ is not only to guard her personal purity, she is also to guard her theological purity. Not to do so is to disobey the Scriptures. It is sin.

In the limited space that I have, I would like to make five observations about doctrinal purity. First, note that, according to I Tim. 4:16, theological impurity poses a very serious threat to the individual and to the group. Paul warned Timothy that maintaining doctrinal purity was essential to his spiritual welfare and also of those who heard him. Theological liberalism would lead to apostasy. We, as individuals, have a biblical

responsibility to guard our own doctrinal purity and the doctrinal purity of our churches and of our denomination.

Second, according to Rom. 16:17, we are to "mark" and "avoid" those, who, because of their theological liberalism, cause divisions and offenses. The word rendered "mark" means "to keep your eye on, to view attentively." It is a present infinitive which suggests continuous action. Doctrinal purity requires an unceasing vigil. It also requires separation from unbelief which is seen in the word "avoid." The impact of this word is seen in its use in I Pet. 3:11, "Let him eschew evil." The form used in the Romans passage is a present imperative. It is a command to continue to do something. Separation from theological liberalism is not optional. God requires it and He requires it on a continuous basis. As a believer, the child of God is commanded to keep a careful watch for those who believe and teach liberal theology and avoid them like he avoids evil. Paul did this in Acts 19:8-9 when he separated himself from the synagogue because there were those who spoke evil of the way. Note that he took the initiative. He moved from the synagogue to the school of Tyrannus.

Third, note that when a group has in its midst those who speak evil of "the way" and they will not deal with them, it is time to withdraw from that group or movement. Paul remained in the synagogue for a period of three months but departed when it became apparent that the body would tolerate unbelief and not deal with it. The passage says, "And he went into the synagogue, and spake boldly for the space of three

(Continued on next page)

months, disputing and persuading the things concerning the kingdom of God. But when divers were hardened, and believed not, but spake evil of that way before the multitude, he departed from them, and separated the disciples, disputing daily in the school of one Tyrannus."

Fourth, it is important to note that Paul felt the need to protect his disciples from theological heresy. He also separated "the disciples" into the school of Tyrannus. He recognized a moral spiritual responsibility in guarding the theological purity of his flock.

Finally, leaders of the flock are not to bring those who represent theological liberalism before their flocks (and this would also include a denominational meeting) and "welcome" them bidding them God's blessings. It is very doubtful that Paul ever asked a couple of those who remained with the synagogue to come and give "greetings" to the Ephesian Christians. This is in keeping with the admonition of the Apostle John who wrote, "If there come any unto you, and bring not this doctrine [the doctrine of Christ], receive him not into your house, neither bid him God speed; For he that biddeth him God speed is a partaker of his evil deeds." This would apply to those who come and the group they represent. Thus, although they themselves might not have spoken evil of the way, if they represent a group which speaks evil of the way, they are not to be invited into our homes, churches, or denominational meetings and given God's blessings. To do so is to disobey God and makes us a partaker of their evil deeds.



FALL ENROLLMENT UP 24%

What a difference a summer makes! Our campus this fall is filled with activity -- new and returning students getting into the swing of "college life." What a thrill to have no available spaces in chapel seating and all the parking places filled in the parking lot. We praise God for each student and are excited about the prospects for the future.

The enrollment breakdown is as follows:

Total enrollment 140

Dorm Students 101
Men 45
Women 56

Off Campus Students 39

Married Students 16

New Students 69

Freshman 63
Sophomore 33
Junior 25
Senior 15
Special 4

Note: This does not include our Extension Studies Program.

NEW STUDENTS COMMENT.....

"Although I had never seen Southeastern, I knew that this was the place for me. Through the encouragements of my youth pastor, I made my decision to attend." JB, NC

"I decided to come to Southeastern because of the friendliness I received when I came here for Get Acquainted Days last year." SC, NC

"Dorm life with the girls is wonderful. Mrs. Fulcher is a terrific dorm Mom!" JS, NC

"I feel I am special and loved here." MH, NC

"The people are so friendly and do so much to make you feel at home." MH, AR

"I think Southeastern is the best place that I could go anywhere in the world in order to find the Lord's will." MH, VA

"The students, as well as the teachers, really care about each other." MS, OH

"It's just a great big family. The Lord is really working through everyone this year." MJ, IN

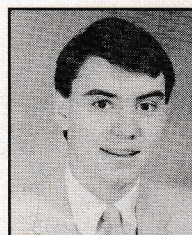
"I chose to attend Southeastern because it's friendly, full of zeal and the work of God is moving forward through this college. I've learned many things that are new to me. Chapel services are always good because of the spirit on campus and the quality of preachers that speak each weekday. If you don't have discipline and determination before you start college here, you will eventually have it. At Southeastern, you will soon realize that you are somebody here." DA, NC



WELCOME TO THE FAMILY

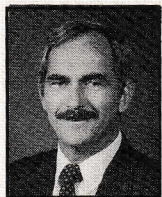
Southeastern's staff family has grown recently with the addition of two new employees.

David Austin has become our new Maintenance Supervisor. David and his wife, Cindy, are originally from Clarksville, Tennessee, and have two sons. David is enrolled at Southeastern as a ministerial student.



David Peterman, originally from Kankakee, Illinois whose home is now Topeka, Kansas, has also joined our staff as bookkeeper. He is enrolled in Southeastern's business program hoping one day to become a CPA. He and his wife, Melinda, reside in Knightdale, North Carolina.

INCREASING OUR WORLD VISION MISSIONS RETREAT



"IS IT YOUR LIFE?" has been chosen as the theme for our first missions retreat which will be held at New Horizon Campground in Blackstone, Virginia, October 19-20. All of our students are being invited to attend this time of fellowship and missions challenge. Bro.

Clint Morgan, missionary to the Ivory Coast, will be speaking to us on Friday evening. The atmosphere will be relaxed and refreshing as we think together about how we can become more involved in world evangelism. Saturday morning, Bro. & Mrs. Bill Fulcher will join Dr. & Mrs. Joe Haas in leading the groups to consider what they can do to help reach the world with the gospel.

Our students are excited about this weekend away from college and we believe that God is going to use this time to bring us to a greater commitment to world evangelism. "Only one life will soon be past, only what's done for Christ will last." Pray for this retreat that it will have a great impact on all of our lives.



FOLLOW ME EIGHTH ANNUAL MISSIONS CONFERENCE

"Follow Me" has been chosen as the theme for the eighth annual Missions Conference at Southeastern.

We must have a renewed interest in missions. It is our desire that pastors and church leaders will come and be with us to be challenged by our speakers, music and missions emphasis during this conference. We believe that we have speakers coming that will challenge and bless you with their preaching: Bro. Lonnie Sparks, missionary to Spain; Bro. Mark Thomas, home missionary working in Greeley, Colorado; Bro. Jack Rollins, pastor of Forestdale Free Will Baptist Church in Birmingham, Alabama; and our own beloved president, Bro. Billy Bevan, pastor of Hilltop Free Will Baptist Church, Fuquay-Varina, NC.

Come and be with us for these exciting days. If you cannot stay for the whole conference, plan to come and spend a day, either Monday or Tuesday. Will you honor us with your presence for these important sessions on missions? Pray for the conference. We are praying that you will be able to come and be with us.



Dates To Remember

October 1-5 Campus Revival
November 1-3 Get Acquainted Days
November 11-13 Missions Conference
November 29-Dec. 1 Tip-Off Tournament
January 1-3 Pastor's Enrichment Retreat

EDUCATION BY EXTERNAL STUDY

Many Christians surrender to the ministry late in life and never have a chance to attend a good traditional school. There are many lay people who would like to have a better knowledge of the Bible who cannot attend a college. There are Sunday School teachers who would like to be better trained. Many preachers have never attended a Bible college.

How are these people going to receive good training? There is an alternative! The answer is education by external study. Thousands today are enrolled in colleges, universities and seminaries by way of external study programs. Some of these are only diploma mills. However, many are very legitimate.

There are hundreds of American colleges and universities which are accredited by agencies recognized by C.O.P.A. and the U.S. Department of Education which offer external study programs. The universities of Alabama, Oklahoma, Tennessee and North Carolina are included in these. These schools offer degrees with little or no residency.

Leaders in Christian education have been slow to respond to the overwhelming need for external continuing education. Some of these leaders have advised potential students not to enroll in an external program, but wait until they can enroll in a traditional school. The sad story is that nine out of ten of these students never enroll in any program at all.

External study has been a large part of the European education process for hundreds of years. It is a growing part of the education system in America. In fact, external education is "the wave of the future" in America.

If you are interested in continuing your education through an external study program, please contact Dr. Johnny Sexton at (919)552-5612.



BEGINNING HIGHLIGHTS

The 1990-91 school year has been launched amid great excitement and anticipation. A number of events highlighted the opening days.

●**LEADERSHIP SEMINAR:** August 20-22. Student leaders arrived early for studies on leadership growth and planning sessions.

●**FRESHMAN ORIENTATION:** August 23-24. This year all freshmen arrived early to get acquainted with college life and for early registration.

●**NEW REGISTRATION PROCEDURES:** Made the whole process a breeze this year along with early registration of others. Shorter lines, fewer forms, more personalized service resulted in many smiles and less problems than ever.

●**GREAT ATMOSPHERE:** Happy students, revival-like chapel services, many opportunities for Christian service, remodeled facilities (especially the new Student Activity Center) have given us a great atmosphere in which to study and learn.

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GIVE A GIFT THAT KEEPS ON GIVING!!!

How would you like to give a 'one-time' gift to the college now that will be the equivalent of giving at least \$10 every month until Jesus comes - even if that blessed event is 100 years from now. Sound interesting? Read on.

Here's how it would work. If you would give a \$1500 'one time' gift to the college, we will place that gift in our special "Student Loan Fund." The interest earned on that \$1500 would be approximately \$10 or more per month - month after month after month.

The very special thing about all this is that not only will your gift be generating this monthly gift but it will also help us provide loans to our students at a very reasonable rate.

The plan is this.

- ★We will loan the money that you give to students.
- ★They will, in turn, pay back that loan.
- ★The interest they pay will go into our general fund.
- ★The principal can then be used to loan to another student.
- ★Then the cycle begins again.

Any money in our loan fund that is not loaned out to

students at any given time will be kept in an interest bearing account. We should easily be able to average an 8% return on our money. 8% of \$1500 is \$120 per year or \$10 per month!

Our goal is to get 40 people to agree to help us. That will provide us with a \$60,000 loan fund to help our students.

Can you help us? If so, simply send in your check and mark it "Loan Fund Gift". We will do the rest. Thank you so much in advance for your generosity.

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DID YOU KNOW...

...a full-time dorm student pays over \$5300 for a year at Southeastern. (This is less than most Christian colleges.)

...the actual cost for that student is over \$9000!

...the additional \$3700 must come from people like you.

Will you send us an extra love offering this month to help us keep down the cost of education for our students?

If you can, please use the envelope provided. Thanks.